

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 40813.57 ▼ 537.36 1.30% NASDAQ 17303.01 ▼ 2.0% STOXX 600 540.44 ▼ 0.1% 10-YR. TREAS. (Reopening) yield 4.275% OIL \$66.55 ▼ \$1.13 GOLD \$2,984.30 ▲ \$45.20 EURO \$1.0855 YEN 147.82

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Donatella Versace** shed her role as creative director of Italian fashion brand Versace and will become the label's chief brand ambassador, parent company Capri said. **A1**
- ◆ **Star Kering designer** Demna will leave Balenciaga to become Gucci's next artistic director at a time of unprecedented transitions at luxury brands. **B3**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** slid, with the S&P 500 falling 1.4% into a correction and the Nasdaq and Dow retreating 2% and 1.3%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Economists estimate** that the Fed's preferred gauge of prices ticked higher in February, extending a stretch of rising costs for consumers. **A2**
- ◆ **Compass is in** advanced talks to acquire Warren Buffett's real-estate brokerage business, the latest sign of consolidation in the industry. **B1**
- ◆ **An arbitrator temporarily** forbade former Meta employee Sarah Wynn-Williams, who is bound by a nondisparagement agreement, from promoting her new tell-all book. **B1**
- ◆ **U.S. convenience-store** sales volume fell by 4.3% as prices rose in the year ended Feb. 23, market-research firm Circana said, with snacks and cigarettes among the casualties. **B1**
- ◆ **Canada's Couche-Tard** will continue its pursuit of 7-Eleven owner Seven & i, executives said, while lamenting the slow progress of acquisition talks. **B2**
- ◆ **Drug companies** Mallinckrodt and Endo agreed to merge and spin off the latter's sterile injectables business from the combined entity at a later date. **B3**

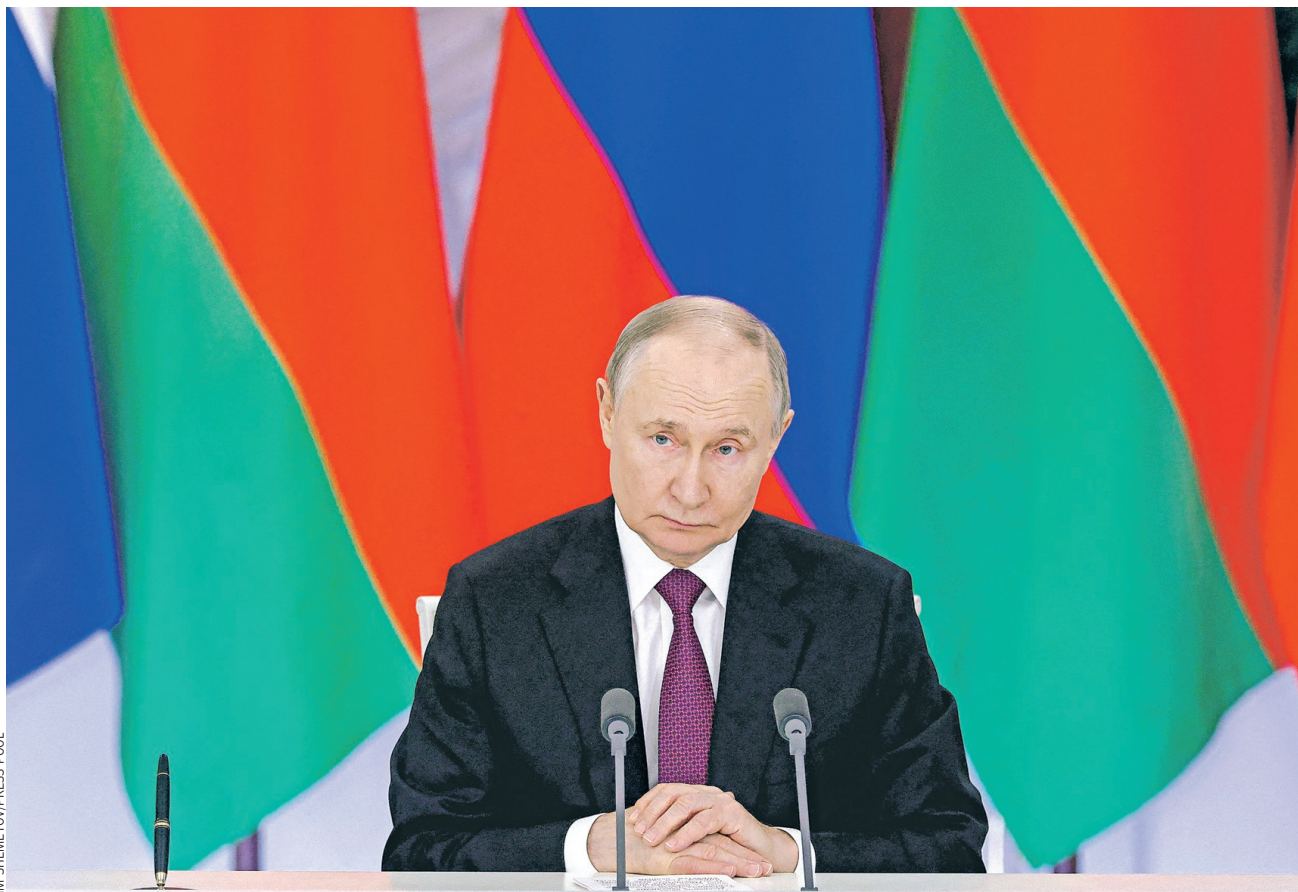
World-Wide

- ◆ **Russia's Putin** said he didn't support an immediate cease-fire in Ukraine, calling instead for more talks on an end to the war as Russian troops made gains toward expelling Kyiv's forces from Kursk. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump escalated** the tariff wars by threatening a retaliatory 200% levy on alcoholic drinks entering the U.S. from the European Union. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump family agents** held talks to take a stake in Binance's U.S. arm, a move that would put the president in business with a crypto exchange that pleaded guilty in 2023 to violating anti-money-laundering rules. **A1**
- ◆ **Senate Democratic leader** Schumer said he would vote for a Republican spending plan, moving to take the threat of a government shutdown off the table. **A4**
- ◆ **Two judges** in different cases blocked the administration's firing of probationary employees at multiple federal agencies, allowing thousands of workers to get their jobs back for now. **A3**
- ◆ **Tensions over** pro-Palestinian protests rose when demonstrators flooded Trump Tower to demand the release of Mahmoud Khalil and Columbia sanctioned students for the occupation of a university building last year. **A3**
- ◆ **The White House** withdrew Trump's nominee to lead the CDC after senators told the administration he didn't have the votes to be confirmed. **A4**
- ◆ **Taiwan's president** said the island would step up efforts to combat Chinese espionage and influence. **A8**

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President Putin on Thursday listed a range of issues that he said needed to be resolved before fighting with Ukraine could end.

Putin Rejects Immediate Pause In Ukraine Fighting Amid Gains

By MATTHEW LUXMOORE AND NATALIE ANDREWS

President Vladimir Putin of Russia said he didn't support an immediate cease-fire in Ukraine, calling instead for more discussion on a permanent end to the war, as Moscow's army made rapid gains toward driving Ukraine's forces out of Russia's Kursk region.

Putin said any pause in fighting now would be in Ukraine's interest because Russia is gaining on the battlefield, and a host of issues would

need to be resolved before a cease-fire could be reached.

"The idea itself is good, and we of course support it, but there are questions we have to discuss," Putin said, referring to a proposed 30-day cease-fire in the war, adding that Russia sought a lasting peace that would need to eliminate the "root causes" of the conflict.

The comments were the first official response from Moscow after Ukraine agreed this week to a U.S.-backed proposal for a pause in the war, now in its fourth year. Putin

spoke as President Trump's special envoy, Steve Witkoff, was due in Moscow to discuss the proposal, according to two U.S. officials.

Trump said Thursday he planned to speak with Putin soon and he was pressing for a speedy end to the conflict. Of Putin's comments, he said, "He put out a very promising statement, but it wasn't complete."

"I'd love to meet with him and talk to him, but we have to get it over with fast," Trump said, sitting next to NATO Secretary-General Mark

Rutte. Asked about the continuing talks with Russia, Trump said they were "very serious" and added: "Hopefully they'll do the right thing."

The cease-fire offer, negotiated by the U.S. and Ukraine in Saudi Arabia, put pressure on the Russian leader to signal a willingness to work toward peace. On Thursday, Putin thanked Trump for bringing attention to a cease-fire in Ukraine, but he also raised a litany of issues that he said needed to be resolved

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Alcohol Lands on Front Line Of Global Trade War

Trump threatens a 200% tariff on European alcohol after EU levies

Alcohol has landed on the front lines of a global trade war, throwing French wines, Irish whiskeys, Kentucky bourbon, Japanese beer and Mexican tequila into the crossfire between the U.S. and its biggest trading partners.

By Laura Cooper, Juliet Chung and Stacy Meichtry

President Trump opened a new front, threatening a 200% tariff on U.S. imports of all alcoholic beverages from the European Union. Trump's salvo was a response to the EU's decision to move forward on a 50% levy on U.S. whiskey.

Thursday's escalation caused panic on both sides of the Atlantic. The news sent the S&P 500 into its first correction since October 2023, with a decline of 1.4% for the day. The technology-heavy Nasdaq Composite fell nearly 2% and the Dow Jones Industrial Average

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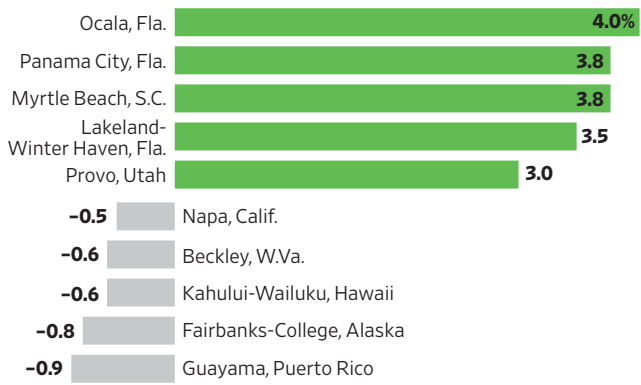
S&P 500 In Correction

S&P 500 drops 1.4%, putting it more than 10% below its Feb. 19 record... B1

Metro Areas Growing Again

Rising immigration in big metropolitan areas that had been shrinking helped offset both a net loss of people moving to other parts of the country and low birthrates. **A3**

Areas with the greatest population change, 2024 from 2023*



*By metropolitan statistical area

Source: Census Bureau

Trump Family Held Deal Talks With Binance After Guilty Plea

Representatives of President Trump's family have held talks to take a financial stake in the U.S. arm of crypto ex-

By Rebecca Ballhaus, Patricia Kowsmann, Angus Berwick, Josh Dawsey and Caitlin Ostroff

change Binance, according to people familiar with the matter, a move that would put Trump in business with the firm that pleaded guilty in

2023 to violating anti-money-laundering requirements.

At the same time, Binance's billionaire founder, Changpeng Zhao—who served four months in prison after pleading guilty to a related charge—has been pushing for the Trump administration to grant him a pardon, people familiar with the matter said. Zhao, widely known as CZ, remains Binance's largest shareholder.

The talks began after Binance reached out to allies of Trump last year offering to

strike a business deal with the family as part of a plan to return the exiled company to the U.S.

It is unclear what form the Trump family stake would take if the deal comes together or whether it would be contingent on a pardon. The possibilities include the Trumps taking the stake or the deal going through World Liberty Financial, a cryptocurrency venture backed by the Trumps that launched in September.

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Clash Ends Versace Era at Versace

By SUZANNE KAPNER

Donatella Versace's decision to step aside as the creative director of the fashion house she inherited followed tensions between the Italian designer and the U.S. corporate chief who was trying to pump up sales by toning down her designs.

On Thursday, the company

said Donatella, 69 years old, would be replaced after nearly three decades and just weeks after showing her latest vibrant designs on a Milan runway. The change comes as her American boss, John Idol, is exploring a potential sale of Versace. Italian rival Prada is interested, people familiar with the situation said.

Idol, a businessman who had built Michael Kors into a global brand, took over family-run Versace in a more-than-\$2-billion deal in 2018. It was the centerpiece of his ambition to turn the company he runs, Capri Holdings, into a U.S. fashion conglomerate on par with European luxury

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Luxury Resorts' Latest Perk: Watch Rocky the Hawk Eat a Bat

Guests pay to see birds hunt, but they won't perform if you give off 'serial killer vibes'

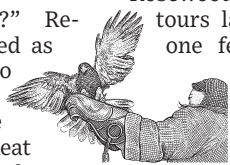
By JIM CARLTON

MENLO PARK, Calif.—It was showtime and Rocky wasn't having it.

"Rocky? Rocky?" Rebecca Rosen pleaded as the hawk refused to budge from a hotel balcony to retrieve a chunk of mouse meat off the gloved arm of a guest at the five-star Rosewood Sand Hill resort in Silicon Valley.

"Come on, buddy," she cooed.

Predator performances are



Flight risk

becoming big business at swanky destinations that are looking to distinguish themselves with unusual perks. Rosewood started its raptor tours last June, including one featuring owls that costs \$175 a person. It's called "Hanging with the Hoots."

Occasionally, the predators will make a kill in front of guests. Rocky once nabbed a bat that flew out from someone's umbrella at an event. "He inhaled it so quickly I

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TOMORROW



WSJ. MAGAZINE

LISA

Trump's Crackdown Had a Head Start At Florida's Colleges

State laws have shifted anxieties and transformed how classes are taught

By DOUGLAS BELKIN

GAINESVILLE, Fla.—Three years ago, as a University of Florida freshman, Bia Castanho kept her head down and her mouth shut when classroom conversations veered toward politics. Virtually every time students with her conservative orientation entered a debate it ended badly for them, she said.

Her time on campus has paralleled a concerted effort by Republican lawmakers to dismantle what they consider entrenched liberal orthodoxy within Florida's institutions of higher learning. In a class this past fall about the economics of farming, she felt emboldened enough to take a stand: Donald Trump was right, illegal immigration was wrong and farmworkers without proper documentation should not be allowed to work, she said.

"Things are changing," said Castanho, now a senior. "When I got here, if you were a conservative, people thought you were a hater, a racist or homophobic. Now at least some people will at least listen to your ideas."

During his presidential campaign, Donald Trump vowed "to reclaim our once great educational institutions from the radical Left." Recent edicts from him and his new administration ordering colleges to end diversity, equity and inclusion programs or anything they deem as discriminatory—or risk losing federal funding—aim to begin the process.

Colleges are rolling back programs that they fear could run afoul of the new administration's guidance and are making other changes. The University of Virginia voted last week to dissolve its DEI

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